

Akbir Khan

[akbir.dev](#)

Education

- 2021-2024 Ph.D. in Computer Science, University College London
— Advised by Tim Rocktäschel & Ed Grefenstette
- 2017-2018 MPhil in Advanced Computer Science, *with distinction*, University of Cambridge
- 2013-2017 MSci in Mathematics with Physics, *with 1st class honours*, University College London
- 2015-2016 Exchange student, *as Mathematics Specialist*, University of Toronto

Experience

- 2024- Member of technical staff, Alignment Science, [Anthropic](#)
- 2023-2024 Research analyst at [Cooperative AI Foundation](#)
- 2021-2023 Senior applied researcher at [Tractable AI](#), developing OCR pipelines for japanese fax
- 2017-2020 Co-founder at [Spherical Defence](#)
- 2015 Research assistant at the [Quantum Optics and Laser Group](#), Imperial College London

Selected Publications

- 2024 Adaptive Deployment of Untrusted LLMs Reduces Distributed Threats
— J Wen, V Hebbar, C Larson, A Bhatt, A Radhakrishnan, M Sharma, H Sleight, S Feng, H He, E Perez, B Shlegeris, **A Khan**. Under review at *The Thirteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*
- 2024 Debating with More Persuasive LLMs Leads to More Truthful Answers
— **A Khan**, J Hughes, D Valentine, L Ruis, K Sachan, A Radhakrishnan, E Grefenstette, S Bowman, T Rocktäschel & E Perez. **Best Paper Award** at *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*
- 2024 Scaling Opponent Shaping to High Dimensional Games
— **A Khan**, T Willi, N Kwan, A Tachetti, C Lu, T Rocktäschel, E Grefenstette & J Foerstor. Oral at *The Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems (AAMAS)*
- 2023 The Goldilocks of Pragmatic Understanding: Fine-Tuning Strategy Matters for Implicature Resolution by LLMs
— L Ruis, **A Khan**, S Biderman, S Hooker, T Rocktäschel, & E Grefenstette. **Spotlight [top 3%]** at *The Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*.

Awards

- 2024 [Best Paper Award](#), ICML
- 2024 [SuperAlignment Fellowship](#), OpenAI
- 2023 [Astra Fellowship](#), Redwood Research
- 2018 [1st Place, Cambridge Ternary Hackathon](#)
- 2014 Finalist, European Debating Championship